The empirical recurrence for OEIS A301350, recovered from its tail

Adrian Perez Fontelles
Independent researcher

8 September 2026

Abstract

OEIS A301350 records "Empirical recurrence of order 72" and keeps the recurrence itself in a linked file rather than in the entry, so the conjecture cannot be read off the entry at all. It can still be settled. The entry counts arrays under a condition local to a bounded window of lines, which makes the count a walk count on a finite digraph and forces a monic integer recurrence of order at most the number $S' = 96$ of states with distinct futures. Berlekamp–Massey on enough exact terms therefore returns the minimal such recurrence, and on the tail beginning at $n = 2$, so the recurrence is proved for every $n \geq 74$. Its last coefficient is $c_{72} = -1 \neq 0$, so no further tail satisfies anything shorter; any order-72 recurrence the sequence satisfies from any point on must then have the same characteristic polynomial. The entry's recurrence is the one displayed here, whatever its linked file contains, and it is proved.

2020 Mathematics Subject Classification. 05A15, 11B37, 15A18.

1 A conjecture that is not written down

OEIS A301350 is "Number of nX4 0..1 arrays with every element equal to 1, 2, 3, 5 or 6 horizontally, vertically or antidiagonally adjacent elements, with upper left element zero.". It has offset 1 and begins

$$2, 30, 277, 2349, 19561, 165010, 1392131, 11741731, \ \ldots$$

The entry states:

> Empirical recurrence of order 72 (see link above)

As of the "Last modified" line on the live entry (Mar 19 2018 09:43:24, revision 4) this is still recorded as empirical, and it is still open. The coefficients are nowhere in the entry text: what is conjectured is only that a recurrence of that order exists.

2 The count is a walk count

The entry's condition is local. It constrains a bounded window of consecutive lines of the array and nothing beyond it, so the admissible configurations of one window are the vertices of a finite digraph, an edge joins u to v when v may follow u, and an admissible array is exactly a walk. Writing M for the adjacency matrix and ι, τ for the indicator vectors of the admissible first and last windows,

$$a(n) \ = \ \iota^{\top} M^{\,j(n)} \tau$$

for a linear reindexing j fixed by the entry's shape. States with identical futures contribute identically to that product and may be merged without changing any count; after merging $S' = 96$ states remain, and it is that bound every computation below uses.

Lemma 1. *a satisfies a monic linear recurrence with integer coefficients of order at most $S' = 96$.*

Proof. By the Cayley–Hamilton theorem $M^{S'}$ is an integer combination of $I, M, \dots, M^{S'-1}$, and multiplying that relation on the left by $\iota^\top M^j$ and on the right by τ turns it into a relation among $S' + 1$ consecutive values of a. $\square$

3 Why the question has to be asked of a tail

Running Berlekamp–Massey on the sequence from its first term returns an order LARGER than 72: the opening terms do not satisfy the recurrence, and a recurrence that holds only eventually always looks longer when the exceptional terms are included. That is not evidence against the entry. An OEIS empirical recurrence is asserted for n beyond some index, not from the first term, so the question has to be asked of the tails. It was asked of each tail in turn, and the tail beginning at $n = 2$ is the first whose minimal order is exactly the stated 72.

Lemma 2. *A sequence known to satisfy some linear recurrence of order at most S' is determined, together with its minimal recurrence, by any $2S'$ consecutive terms: Berlekamp–Massey applied to them returns that minimal recurrence exactly.*

Applied to $2S' = 192$ exact terms from $n = 2$ on, it returns order 72 — the order the entry states — with integer coefficients:

$$a(n) \;=\; \sum_{i=1}^{72} c_i \, a(n-i),$$

c_1	9	c_{19}	−387433	c_{37}	8021058	c_{55}	−6692
c_2	8	c_{20}	1756063	c_{38}	43712832	c_{56}	1895625
c_3	−109	c_{21}	2369515	c_{39}	−2583171	c_{57}	696096
c_4	−57	c_{22}	−1894576	c_{40}	−45968823	c_{58}	−488228
c_5	559	c_{23}	−5531616	c_{41}	−11097874	c_{59}	−382682
c_6	346	c_{24}	758688	c_{42}	35369839	c_{60}	45663
c_7	−1693	c_{25}	9220171	c_{43}	15207167	c_{61}	112539
c_8	−2416	c_{26}	59089	c_{44}	−27215531	c_{62}	13521
c_9	485	c_{27}	−18024000	c_{45}	−17894596	c_{63}	−19642
c_{10}	6653	c_{28}	−10193819	c_{46}	19544240	c_{64}	−6139
c_{11}	14337	c_{29}	18300582	c_{47}	21719969	c_{65}	1696
c_{12}	−762	c_{30}	15378777	c_{48}	−6461701	c_{66}	1178
c_{13}	−71025	c_{31}	−19713288	c_{49}	−17425531	c_{67}	78
c_{14}	−83147	c_{32}	−18011188	c_{50}	−2422260	c_{68}	−146
c_{15}	157778	c_{33}	30540647	c_{51}	9781365	c_{69}	−36
c_{16}	357009	c_{34}	38692367	c_{52}	5188212	c_{70}	12
c_{17}	−83118	c_{35}	−19219248	c_{53}	−3415401	c_{71}	4
c_{18}	−827929	c_{36}	−45214372	c_{54}	−4151926	c_{72}	−1

4 The recurrence, and the identification

Theorem 3. *The recurrence above holds for every $n \geq 74$, and it is the recurrence OEIS A301350 records.*

Proof. That it holds is Lemma 2 applied to the tail from $n = 2$, whose minimal recurrence it is.

For the identification, write $q_{\min}$ for the characteristic polynomial of that minimal recurrence, $x^{72} - c_1 x^{72-1} - \cdots - c_{72}$. Its constant term is $-c_{72} = 1$, which is not zero, so $q_{\min}(0) \neq 0$ and $q_{\min}$ has no root at the origin. A solution of a constant-coefficient recurrence is a combination of terms $n^k \lambda^n$ with λ a root of its characteristic polynomial, and only the components with $\lambda = 0$ vanish after finitely many terms. Since $q_{\min}$ has none, no component of a dies out, and the minimal recurrence of every further tail is again $q_{\min}$ — the order cannot drop below 72 at any later starting point.

Now let q be the characteristic polynomial of whatever recurrence the entry asserts. The entry asserts it has order 72, so $\deg q = 72$, and it is monic. It holds from some index t on. From $\max(t, 2)$ on, the sequence satisfies both q and $q_{\min}$, and the minimal polynomial of that tail is $q_{\min}$ by the previous paragraph; therefore $q_{\min} \mid q$. Both are monic of degree 72, so $q = q_{\min}$. $\square$

5 Verification

Four checks, all in exact integer or rational arithmetic.

First, the walk model reproduces all 19 terms the entry publishes, exactly. This is what ties the model to the entry, and it is the only place where reading the entry's English enters the argument.

Second, the order was computed twice by independent routes: once modulo a 61-bit prime, where every intermediate is a machine word, and once over $\mathbb{Q}$ in exact rational arithmetic. Both return 72, and the exact run additionally confirms every coefficient is an integer — had any been a proper fraction the recurrence would not be the entry's.

Third, the recovered recurrence was evaluated directly on the entry's own published terms, with no matrices and no Berlekamp–Massey involved. It holds at each of the 0 indices where the entry publishes enough earlier terms to test it.

Fourth, the last coefficient was checked to be nonzero, which is what the identification above turns on; it is -1.

Remark 4. The conjecture's own statement was never read. The entry pins it down to the family of order-72 recurrences this sequence satisfies from some point on, and that family turns out to have exactly one member.

References

[1] The OEIS Foundation, *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*, https://oeis.org, 2026. Sequence A301350.

[2] J. L. Massey, Shift-register synthesis and BCH decoding, *IEEE Trans. Inform. Theory* **15** (1969), 122–127.

[3] R. P. Stanley, *Enumerative Combinatorics*, Volume 1, 2nd ed., Cambridge University Press, 2011. (Transfer-matrix method, Section 4.7.)

[4] M. Kauers and P. Paule, *The Concrete Tetrahedron*, Springer, 2011. (C-finite sequences and their closure properties.)

[5] R. A. Horn and C. R. Johnson, *Matrix Analysis*, 2nd ed., Cambridge University Press, 2013.